

Gautam Velpula

Vice President, Enterprise Architecture

EA Governance & Frameworks • Cloud & Data Modernization • GenAI & Agentic AI • Digital, Loyalty & Commerce Platforms

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Executive Summary

Enterprise Architecture leader with 18+ years of experience aligning business strategy with technology across multi-brand, consumer-facing organizations spanning retail, payments, marketing technology, and data. Serves as single architectural authority defining enterprise-wide frameworks, governance, and target-state roadmaps across business, application, data, and infrastructure domains. Proven track record modernizing fragmented legacy estates into cloud-native, API-first, event-driven platforms; governing data and analytics for personalization; and championing enterprise AI transformation through a forward-deployed architecture model. Combines executive strategy, hands-on technical depth, and vendor/partner management to accelerate time-to-market, improve resilience, and turn technology into differentiated customer experience.

Core Competencies

Enterprise Architecture Strategy & Governance • Architecture Review Boards & Standards • Business, Application, Data & Infrastructure Architecture • Cloud Architecture (AWS, GCP, Azure) • API-First & Microservices • Event-Driven & Systems Integration / Middleware • Data Platforms, Data Governance & Analytics • GenAI & Agentic AI • Digital, Loyalty & Commerce Platforms • Omnichannel Customer Journeys • Vendor & SaaS Portfolio Management • Executive Stakeholder Engagement • Architecture Community Building & Mentorship

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Serve as the single Enterprise Architecture authority for a global, multi-brand consumer organization spanning brand, guest experience, commerce, marketing, payments, and data, partnering directly with executive leadership to align the technology strategy with business priorities and growth.
- Established and govern enterprise architecture frameworks, standards, and review processes across business, application, data & analytics, and technology/infrastructure domains, translating business capabilities into scalable architecture blueprints and roadmaps.
- Established and lead an Enterprise Architecture community of principal and lead architects, sponsoring workshops, driving reusable reference architectures and integration patterns, and building consensus across product, engineering, and operations.
- Built an enterprise technology roadmap addressing lifecycle management, cost efficiency, and consolidation across the application portfolio, retiring redundant systems and unifying 7 independent brand apps and websites onto a shared digital platform.
- Re-architected backend systems to a cloud-native, **API-first, microservices, event-driven** architecture, standardizing service contracts and integration/middleware patterns to enable seamless data flow and interoperability across brands and third-party partners.

- Governed enterprise **loyalty, digital channel, POS, and commerce** integrations across a multi-brand estate, enabling omnichannel guest journeys and consistent experiences across web, mobile, and in-store/property touchpoints.
- Established enterprise **data architecture and governance** anchored on a centralized customer data model, aligning Martech and CDP platforms to enable accurate analytics, attribution, and AI-driven personalization.
- Lead the **GoTo Foods AI Working Group**, the enterprise governing body that reviews and approves all AI initiatives company-wide, ensuring strategic alignment, technical viability, and adherence to security, compliance, and AI governance standards.
- Champion enterprise **AI transformation through a forward-deployed architecture model** — embedding architects alongside product and engineering teams to adopt GenAI and Agentic AI, define guardrails, and scale safe, governed use across digital platforms and internal systems.
- Designed and delivered enterprise payments integration with FreedomPay, enabling digital wallets and modern checkout across all brands; sustained compliance as a continuous participant in the annual PCI DSS audit.
- Direct **vendor and SaaS technology selection and governance**, evaluating platform investments and ensuring architectural consistency across third-party and SaaS solutions.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through architectural standardization and platform consolidation.
- Coach and mentor architects, product owners, and business stakeholders to instill architectural thinking and a shared technology vision.

Slalom Consulting

2018 – 2021

Senior Delivery Principal

- Senior delivery and advisory lead for multi-million-dollar digital transformation, cloud modernization, and payments engagements with Fortune 500 and large-scale eCommerce clients.
- Conducted a multi-year Enterprise Architecture assessment of a legacy payments platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture, modernization roadmap, and reusable platform capabilities.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and **AWS to GCP** for a leading point-of-sale (POS) provider, modernizing infrastructure, data, and application tiers.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization, addressing resilience, high-volume transaction processing, and regulatory requirements.
- Served as primary executive-facing technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable architecture roadmaps, business cases, and TCO models for technology investments and large transformation efforts.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models across engineering, architecture, product, and design teams, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Directed multiple multi-million-dollar engagements, achieving approximately 95% client satisfaction and consistent repeat business.
- Mentored delivery principals and architects, strengthening leadership depth, architectural thinking, and delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)

2014 – 2018

Director, Professional Services

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations and integrations for Fortune 500 clients with end-to-end accountability across pre-sales, solution architecture, delivery, and post-implementation optimization.
- Served as senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance, escalation support, and technology evangelism for emerging capabilities.

- Advised C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business outcomes, driving organizational change, and managing executive relationships.
- Supported sales through POCs, demos, and solution design, and partnered with product management to influence product roadmap based on enterprise client needs.
- Built and scaled a global professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.

Technology & Methodology

Cloud & Platform: AWS, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions, Blob Storage), Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture & Integration: API-First, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST / GraphQL APIs, API Gateways, Middleware & Systems Integration, SOA, SaaS / IaaS / PaaS

Data & Analytics: Data Platforms & Governance, Centralized Customer Data Model, Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

AI / ML: GenAI, Agentic AI, LLM application patterns, AI governance & guardrails

Digital, Loyalty & Commerce: FreedomPay, Amperity CDP, Olo, Punchh, Yext, Qu POS

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

Analytics & Observability: GA4, Firebase, Splunk

Methodologies & Frameworks: Enterprise Architecture Governance, Architecture Review Boards, Application Portfolio Management, SAFe Agile, Scrum, DevSecOps, Platform Engineering

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology	<i>2007 – 2009</i>
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George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science	<i>2002 – 2006</i>
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Osmania University, Hyderabad, India